Yawara SHEP

JIU-JITSU INSTRUCTOR COURSE

Instructor Course

TEXTBOOK

Previous Edition





CONTENTS Table of contents

01 How to Think About Jiu-Jitsu PHILOSOPHY 3

- Introduction 3
- The Structure of Jiu-Jitsu 4
- Putting Sparring into Words 5
- The Overall Flow of Jiu-Jitsu 5
- Reflexive Defense Responses 6
- Options Within the Flow 6

02 Coaching Basics COACHING 8

- The Basics of Teaching Jiu-Jitsu 8
- Presence (How You Carry Yourself) 9

03 Jiu-Jitsu Theory THEORY 11

- The Defense Line 11
- Jiu-Jitsu Theory 12

04 Guard Passing PASSING 16

- Guard Passing 16
- Three Types of Guard Pass 20
- Types of Pin 21

05 Guard GUARD 23

- Guard 23

06 Pins and Submissions SUBMISSION 27

- Pinning 27
- Submissions From Side Control 29
- Submissions 33

07 Movement MOVEMENT 39

- Headstand 39
- Shrimp 40
- Reverse Shrimp 40
- Forward Roll 41
- Back Roll 42
- Barbosa Shrimp 42
- Crab 43
- Seated Guard 43
- Technical Stand-Up 43
- Gorilla 44
- Crocodile 45
- Dog 45

08 Basic Drills DRILLS 46

- Guard Pass Drill 46
- Armbar Drill 47
- Triangle Drill 49
- Kimura Drill 50
- Omoplata Drill 51
- Spider Drill 51
- Lasso Drill 52
- Jump Pass Drill 52
- Guard Pass Drill (Stepping) 53
- Toreando Pass 53
- Leg Drag 54
- Knee-Pin Pass Drill 54
- Tomoe Drill 55
- Kuru-Kuru 56
- Side Control Drill 57

CHAPTER 01

How to Think About Jiu-Jitsu

PHILOSOPHY

Introduction

A Jiu-Jitsu Program Where Anyone Can Get Strong

Because jiu-jitsu is a contact sport, some people get strong on feel alone, and those are often the people who end up teaching it. Coasting on that feel, they don't worry about students who progress slowly. They tell themselves those students are just slower than the ones who are improving, and the mood becomes "as long as it's fun, that's fine." But jiu-jitsu is more than just training hard. Behind it lie the essence it took from the martial arts and a solid logic of techniques and of how things work. Teach students to understand and embody these, and you can speed up how fast they grow.

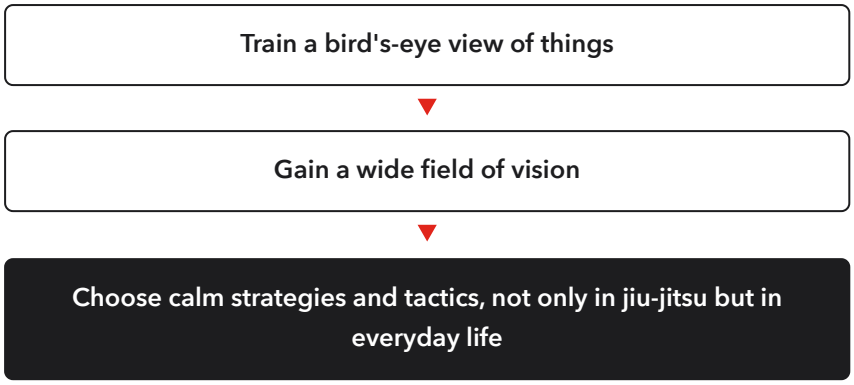
Doing jiu-jitsu means, first of all, getting strong (good) at jiu-jitsu. That is how you gain "strength" as a human being. And because jiu-jitsu is a relative exchange with an opponent, it trains you to see things from a bird's-eye view. In other words, you develop a wide field of vision, and you become able to choose calm strategies and tactics not only in jiu-jitsu but in everyday life. Through jiu-jitsu, a person's business and daily life grow richer.

This course therefore has three aims: ① learn the basic theory of jiu-jitsu, ② learn how to teach white and blue belts, and ③ become able to teach YAWARA's programs (jiu-jitsu and movement) correctly to people with no athletic background. In doing so we will train instructors who can deliver "a jiu-jitsu program where anyone can get strong." To build your own ability, you will also study systematically: establishing "your own style" that wins at the colored belts, understanding the system of jiu-jitsu and being clear about what to prioritize, strengthening your ability to handle positions so you get strong quickly, and gaining a detailed, deep understanding of the rules so you can gain the upper hand in matches.

YAWARA's Jiu-Jitsu

- By getting strong (good) at jiu-jitsu, you gain strength as a human being
- Train a bird's-eye view of things → your field of vision widens and you can apply it to your own business

※ "Losing weight," "health," "having fun," and "stress relief" are all by-products



Goals of YAWARA Jiu-Jitsu Academy

1. Learn the basic theory of jiu-jitsu
2. Learn how to teach white and blue belts
3. Become able to teach YAWARA's programs (jiu-jitsu and movement) correctly to people with no athletic background

The Structure of Jiu-Jitsu

Understand That It Is a Relative Relationship

Jiu-jitsu starts with defense. You defend while controlling your opponent, and only once you have them firmly controlled do you go for the submission. That is the structure of jiu-jitsu. But regular classes mostly practice how to apply techniques, so people tend to think "I have to attack" and often jump straight to the submission. So why shouldn't you attack right away? You need to ask yourself: "Why does the same technique work on some people and not on others?"

Unlike bowling, darts, or golf, jiu-jitsu is a relative exchange with an opponent. When you roll a bowling ball, throw a dart, or hit a golf ball, nobody interferes with the motion itself, and you can carry it out entirely on your own terms. So form, muscle strength, flexibility, and body coordination all come directly into play. In jiu-jitsu, though, there is always an exchange with an opponent. It never goes purely on your terms, and you are always affected by the other person. For example, if a submission that finishes on lower belts doesn't finish on higher belts, then what you need to do changes with the opponent. In other words, whether a technique works is decided within the relative relationship between you and your opponent.

Normally nobody interferes when you roll a bowling ball. Jiu-jitsu is what happens when somebody does. That is why you first defend, keep constant track of your opponent's situation, and control them, creating a situation where your submission can't be interfered with. Once you understand this, it should be clear that you can't improve at jiu-jitsu through "power" alone.



Putting Sparring into Words

To control an opponent from defense, you need to feel them. But if you are tensing up, you can't feel them. Being out of breath after a three- or five-minute round is proof that you were tensing up. Unexpected events also tire you out, so you need to be the one leading (controlling) your opponent.

For example, on the feet, if you put your right hand forward, your opponent comes to grab that right sleeve. If they then pull guard, you step your right foot forward. They put a De La Riva guard on that right foot. Moving your opponent exactly as you predicted is what it means to control them. In sparring, what matters is working with this awareness: is your opponent moving the way you intended? Within that, check whether things went off track or not, and correct them. Once you can do this, you can put your entire sparring session into words.

The Overall Flow of Jiu-Jitsu

Be Clear About What You Should Do Now

The overall flow of jiu-jitsu is the process from the start until one person finishes a submission. Within this process there are five positions: "Defense (1:9)," "Escaping a pin," "5:5," "Breaking the opponent's balance and applying a technique," and "Attack (9:1)." The important thing is to **always know which of these five positions in the flow you are in right now (where you are)**.

When you always know where you are, you can make a clear plan for what you should do now and where you are heading, and move toward it. Only then do the causes of both your successes and your failures become clear and feed your growth. If you move around blindly without knowing where you are, you get lost and end up submitted without understanding how. You attack when you should be defending and get submitted instead. And since you have no idea what happened, there is no way to improve.

The same goes for business. If you can't clearly identify the causes of success and failure, you can't reproduce the success, and you will repeat the same failure. In jiu-jitsu, too, you have to pursue the causes of your successes and failures. For that, it is essential to always keep this mindset: which position am I in within the overall flow, what should I do now, and what am I aiming for?

From the guard position



Always know clearly which position you are in within the flow

Make a clear plan for what to do now and where you are heading, then move

Only then do the causes of success and failure become clear

People also tend to assume that the moment a match starts is "5:5." But if your opponent is a higher belt or a stronger player, for example, you should consider that the moment you pull guard you are starting not from "5:5" but from "Defense (1:9)."

Reflexive Defense Responses

The Mechanism for Gaining the Upper Hand

Jiu-jitsu is fundamentally a sport with a built-in mechanism: you use reflexive defense responses to gain the upper hand in the fight.

Examples of Reflexive Defense Responses

Protective extension response (parachute response)

The response where both hands shoot forward quickly when you are about to fall.

※ For example, posting both hands on the mat when your opponent rocks you forward with their legs from closed guard

Hopping response

The response where you take a step to catch yourself when you are about to lose your balance forward, backward, or to the side.

※ For example, in a sickle sweep, denying this step makes it easy to tip the opponent backward

> **If you move on reflex instead of making reasoned decisions, you play right into the hands of anyone stronger than you**

If you just react on reflex from moment to moment, you get submitted before you know what happened.

People tend to blame their struggles in jiu-jitsu on "strength," "stamina," or "mental toughness." That's wrong. **The biggest factor is lacking the "humble awareness (ability) to pursue the cause of your failures."**

When you get caught in a triangle, the usual response is to struggle and try to escape somehow. But in training, that is the moment to tap. Why? Because there is nothing more to be gained from that exchange. The only outcomes left are getting injured or getting choked out. Even if you muscle your way out, you learn nothing from it. What matters is clearly understanding what was happening two or three moves before you got caught. You need to check, understand, and correct things like "That happened because my arm got lifted here" or "That's because I lunged forward trying to pass."

So instead of moving on reflex, you keep repeating these questions within the overall movement: "Where am I now?" "What am I aiming for from here?" "To get there, where should I work first?" Through this repetition you come to move naturally, without thinking about it. Logical movement becomes your reflex (roughly purple to brown belt level).

Options Within the Flow

Be Proactive in Both Attack and Defense

Thinking from guard position, the more you are put on the defensive, the fewer options you have. When you are on the verge of tapping, your only option is to tap. On the other hand, on the attack in high mount your options expand: you can finish the neck, finish the elbow or the wrist, go back to knee on belly, take the back, and so on.

From the guard position



Defense
Your options are **few**

Attack
Your options are **many**

Seen this way, defense may seem passive, but it isn't. By defending proactively, you can make your opponent launch the attacks you expected. In other words, you can control your opponent while letting them attack. If you can defend while reading their attacks ahead of time, you can handle exchanges without needing much explosive speed.

CHAPTER 02

Coaching Basics

COACHING

The Basics of Teaching Jiu-Jitsu

Cueing

Cueing is central to teaching.

Cueing means conveying instructions to someone through words or signals. Broadly, there are four kinds: "what," "how," "when," and "encouragement." The methods are visual cueing, verbal cueing, feeling cueing, and motivation cueing.

Visual cueing (teaching by showing)

This way of giving instructions works on sight: you show the movement. Mirroring matters when you demonstrate. When facing students, the instructor must do everything in the opposite direction (saying "raise your left hand" while raising their own right hand). When standing beside a student, you need to demonstrate at a speed that matches them.

Verbal cueing (teaching with words)

This way of giving instructions works on hearing: you use words to convey the purpose of the movement, its direction, the body parts used, the number of reps, points to watch, and so on. Don't use vague words like "this way" or "over there." It is important to give concrete cues in words that would make sense even with your eyes closed. Also use as few words as possible and aim to draw out the movement. For example, when you want someone to straighten their elbow, say "reach your right fingertips out as far as they'll go," and the elbow straightens by itself.

Feeling cueing

This method gives instructions through analogies matched to the person's level of abstraction. When crossing the hands, saying "like turning a steering wheel" makes the image easy to picture. But someone who has never driven a car will struggle to picture that, so have several analogies ready that the person can relate to, so that one of them catches and the image comes.

Motivation cueing

Watch your students closely, find what they are doing well, and tell them: "I've never seen anyone do it this well," "You've got this part." You can also make someone aware of their progress by making a big deal of a small change. Say "your triangle is getting really good," and they may start focusing on the triangle in training.

> **When a correction is needed, don't stop at the correction. Tell them when they get it right afterward. Correction and praise must always go together.**

Presence (How You Carry Yourself)

The Pygmalion effect

The Pygmalion effect is a term from educational technology for the phenomenon where people perform better when others expect them to. Say something like "So-and-so, you always do your homework, don't you? Even though you don't look the type," and they will feel they have no choice but to do it. When an instructor believes a student can do it and expects it of them, that reaches the student.

The Golem effect

People perform worse when those around them show no expectation of them or interest in them. Students who are seen as "this one will never get it" fall behind. It is important to treat them with the belief that they will get there, even if it takes time.

The energy of the room

When someone who could never do something finally does it, the people around them, and they themselves, start believing they can do it too. When the first person in history ran the 100m in under ten seconds, the number of people running under ten seconds then rose sharply.

Setting the environment

A small thing that feels off can ruin a class. Pay attention to the music volume, the air-conditioning temperature, and the tone and rhythm of your voice. When a student is disrupting the room, you also need to speak to them firmly. Design the class so that every student takes it in the same way, with the same feeling.

Encouragement

Another important role of the instructor is to create an atmosphere where people feel "this is fine," with words like "nobody can do it at first" or "you're doing well for your level." Learn to spot small changes and tell students about them. Then students feel "someone is really watching me," and their sense of security and their motivation go up.

Use both logic and feeling

Human thinking comes in two kinds: logical and intuitive. It varies by person. Some are stronger in logical thinking, others in intuitive thinking, and this applies to both instructors and students. For example, if an instructor who leans logical teaches only logically, students who lean intuitive will find the teaching hard to follow.

So that every type of student can understand, the instructor must be able to give both logical and intuitive explanations. If you can weave the logical and the intuitive together while teaching a single technique, you become

an instructor everyone can understand. If you lean logical, make a habit of explaining things by feel in everyday situations, and you will become more balanced.

CHAPTER 03

Jiu-Jitsu Theory

THEORY

The Defense Line

The Six Stages

①	In closed guard or a specific guard, able to break the opponent's balance however you like
②	Not letting the opponent control the soles of your feet
③	Stopping the opponent with your shins or similar
④	Lower body is controlled, but you are stopping the opponent with the frame of your arms
⑤	Passed, but your hands and feet are still free
⑥	Passed, and your hands and feet are no longer free



① You can off-balance them at will



⑥ No freedom in your limbs

> **It is important to be able to recognize which of the six stages you are in right now**

Even in black belt matches, people misjudge these six stages. They attack when they should be defending and get passed or submitted. It is important to choose your position and movements consciously. When you can't choose (when you are being controlled by your opponent), don't force your way toward a better position. First, hold the position you're in.

For example, say you are at the last line of defense against a guard pass and have just got into half guard. If you force your way back to guard from there, your opponent may exploit the opening and pull their leg free. What matters is not forcing your way to a better position but first holding that position firmly. The same applies when you are coaching in someone's corner. In a moment when you should be keeping them in position with "Don't let go of that grip, no matter what," you shout "Get your feet on them and recover guard!" or "Sweep!" and they get passed.

Jiu-Jitsu Theory

7 Points

① Always pull your knees in toward your torso (in guard)

Whether a guard pass succeeds depends on how far your opponent can get their body into the space between your hips and chest. So the guard player must pull the elbows and knees in and keep them out of that space. When you haven't established a specific guard or haven't got grips, pull your knees to your sides and externally rotate your hips. External rotation lets you use big muscles (the gluteus maximus, the muscle of the buttocks), so you can produce strong force and tire less.




Once your guard is properly established, it is no problem if your legs are extended and the space between your hips and chest is open. Even if the opponent grabs your pants and backs away, sit up to respond so that this space doesn't open.






② Close the distance when you are ahead; make distance and space when you are behind

The foundation of every combat sport is distance. In a bad position, having no space takes away your options and leaves you unable to do anything. Yet people make the error of closing the distance themselves, hugging their opponent while underneath them in side control or half guard. People also fixate on a grip and hold it forever, but the whole point of a grip is to close the distance to your opponent. So when you are in a bad position and your opponent has closed the distance, you need to let go of the grip and switch to a frame.

③ Switching between grips and frames

If your opponent gets past your legs and is about to pass, and you are still holding your grip, you have no frame and you will be passed. So once they are past your legs, let go of the grip and switch to a frame immediately.

※ If your feet are planted on them, or their body is between your legs, it's OK to keep the grip

Once they are past your legs, release the grip, immediately make a frame with your hands (the technical stand-up movement), and create distance from your opponent.



A frame lines up your arm and core in a straight line, like a single piece of architecture. This forms a strong frame without relying on muscular strength. When you are about to be crushed, people also try to straighten their elbows and push back to make space, but that means relying on muscular strength, and it's hard. Don't try to straighten your elbows and push back. Instead, keep the frame built from your humerus, shoulder blade, and core from moving, and shrimp to make space.



④ Recovering in guard

When you are too late to frame, time it with your opponent coming in: hug their arm firmly, push the mat with your opposite elbow as if it were a frame, and rotate forward to turn onto your stomach. The key is to clamp your arm hard to your side and hug their arm tightly. Squeezing downward and shifting a little forward makes it hard for them to pull their arm out. Then raise your hips high, and the rotation gets easier.



⑤ About frames

A frame is mainly a structure of bones. Pushing with your hands relies on muscle contraction and is exhausting. Even when you are about to be pinned from side control, don't push with your hands. What matters is building a frame with the minimum of bone and creating space. Put your knee into that space and fix your position.

Understand that a frame is a structure, so the word doesn't refer only to the hands. As in the photo at lower left, the structure runs from the left elbow through the left shoulder blade and the core to the right buttock. In other words, it looks as if you are pushing with the left elbow, but you are actually pushing with the right buttock. When this structure collapses, you get crushed all at once.





One example of using structure well is how to apply pressure from half guard. When you are on top in half guard, rather than using your physical strength to pull your opponent in and create pressure, use your foot as the pivot, straighten your knee, and build an arch structure. The pressure becomes far stronger. Once you can use structure like this, you understand that jiu-jitsu isn't about strength (some black belts still don't understand this).





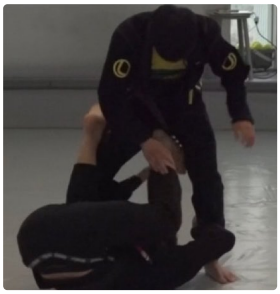
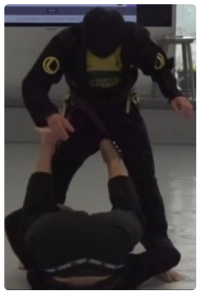
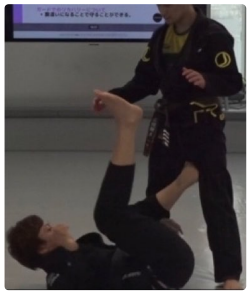
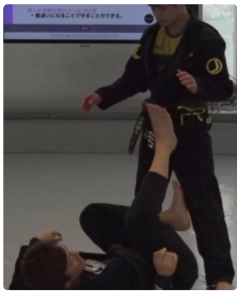
The foundation of jiu-jitsu is controlling your opponent. To control them, people try to hold them down by force, but force always has a limit. So it is important to fight with structure (especially arch structure), not strength. In the photo at upper left, you are supported at three points: foot, knee, and shoulder (upper body). Your weight is on your foot and knee, so you have to use your arms to apply pressure by force. In the photo at upper right, the knee is lifted and you are supported at two points, foot and shoulder (upper body), so your weight rests fully on your upper body. Because you are using structure rather than strength, you can apply even stronger pressure without tiring.

⑥ On the bottom, if you get underhooked, consider yourself dead

If you are on your side on the bottom, you will almost never get underhooked, but once your back is on the mat the risk rises. If you get underhooked on the bottom, consider it pretty much over. There are instructional videos on how to respond once you get underhooked, but they don't work in real matches. So you absolutely must not get underhooked. Don't practice what to do after it's in. Practice not letting it in.

⑦ When you're in trouble, put your head inside

For example, when you get toreando-passed, put your head between your opponent's legs and turn in the same direction you are being rotated, and you can get back to inverted guard. Opponents crash into you to pass. If you can respond not only head-on and in a straight line, with force, but also in a circle, your guard gets much stronger.

CHAPTER 04

Guard Passing

PASSING

Guard Passing

Hold the Position Before You Pass

At YAWARA, the program is built mainly around establishing guard. The reason: unless you have a judo background, you have almost no chance of winning on the feet. It is easier to score by first pulling guard, establishing it, and then going for sweeps. In guard on the bottom you can use all four limbs, while on top you mainly use your two hands. It's four against two, so sweeping from bottom guard is relatively easy. That is why a sweep is worth 2 points. Handling that guard, passing it, and pinning is harder, so a guard pass is worth 3.

In the flow of a match, you will always end up on top at some point. Sweep from the bottom and you are on top. But if you are bad on top and can't do anything, you get swept right back. So you need to develop a solid understanding of top position too.

What Happens Next From Top Position (Six Main Patterns)

1. You get caught in a submission such as a triangle choke from bottom position
2. You get swept
3. **You hold the position as it is**
4. You pass the guard and pin
5. You take the back or mount with a special technique (berimbolo, etc.)
6. You jump in and finish a triangle choke or ankle lock

Of these, "③ You hold the position as it is" is the one to focus on most. If you can't even hold the position and still go for the pass, of course it won't work. Don't worry about passing at first. What matters is how well you can hold the position as it is, without being swept or submitted. So the first goal on top is to "hold the position as it is."

The condition for holding the position is to "win the grip fight." Winning the grip fight means you are controlling your opponent. In other words, their movement is more restricted than yours. Conversely, you are losing the grip fight when you are the one restricted (you want to stand but can't, for example). The first key to winning the grip fight is "don't leave your hands idle." White belts especially often grip nothing and leave their hands idle. Start by gripping anywhere, then re-grip somewhere better. Just gripping restricts your opponent's movement.



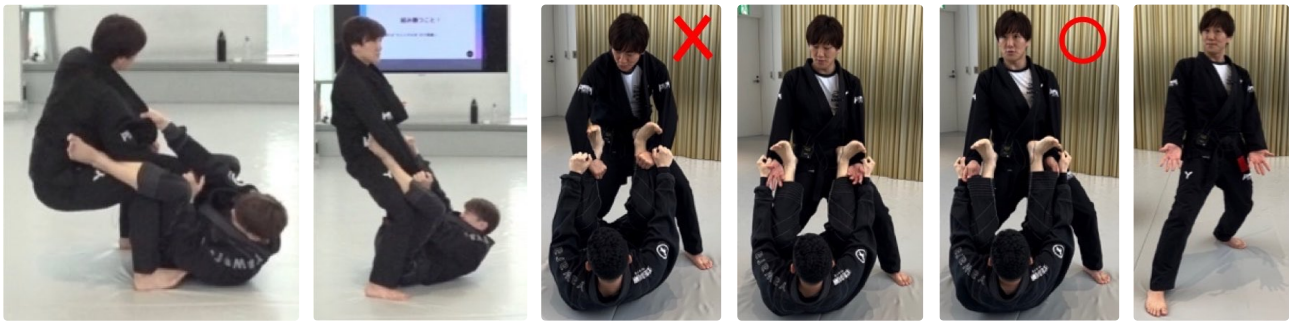
If you do lose the grip fight, it is important to reset right away. Sometimes you reset by giving up the position, and sometimes you can reset by changing your posture. People go for a pass, a triangle choke, or a kimura while losing the grip fight, but the top priority is the reset. **You may attack only when you are winning the grip fight.**

On top, when your collar is gripped and your head is pulled down, you are suddenly far more restricted. So when your head gets pulled down, sit back to reset. From there, puff out your chest or strip the grip with your hands.



Hanging back

Once you get the feel of hanging your weight backward, you can post a strong base without using force. Clamp your arms to your sides and grip with your thumbs pointing outward, and it gets very hard on your opponent. Also stick your chest out straight so that your knees, hips, and shoulders form a straight line. This is especially effective as a base against guards like spider guard that try to break your balance forward or to the side.



Think about which way you risk falling

To avoid being swept, think about which way you risk falling and build a base that won't fall. In a sickle sweep, you fall backward when the direction of your opponent's push lines up with the direction of your heel. So shift your heel off the line of their push (turn your toes inward, for example) and you can keep your balance. Also drive your knee forward to create a situation where they can't kick. In lasso guard, you get swept toward the side where the lasso is on. So if you set your base firmly on the side without the lasso, you won't be swept.



In any guard, always think about which way you can be swept, and take a base that prevents it. There is also no perfect base that won't fall in any direction. **A base that is strong in one direction is weak in another. Being strong and not falling forward means you fall backward more easily. This is an absolute law of jiu-jitsu.** So you must keep changing your base as the situation changes, and in jiu-jitsu whoever outfoxes the other wins the close battles. Knowledge and experience decide this sport, so the higher the level, the less physical ability alone will get you.

Creating a stalemate is also a technique

Before you can pass, you first have to not get beaten, so how well you hold the current position is what matters. So what does a posture that can't be beaten look like? For example, when you are caught in someone's closed guard, what do you do to avoid being swept or submitted for one minute?



Let's think about "lute" here. Why does the "lute" rule exist? However big the skill gap, a stalemate can always be created. In a stalemate, nobody can sweep and nobody can submit. The match doesn't move, so "lute" exists as a penalty. Seen another way, though, a stalemate is a state where you are holding the current position without anything being done to you. Fifteen seconds of continuous stalemate gets you a lute, but break the stalemate at 12 seconds and, under the rules, no lute is called. In other words, if your goal is to avoid getting beaten, creating a stalemate is a valid tool.

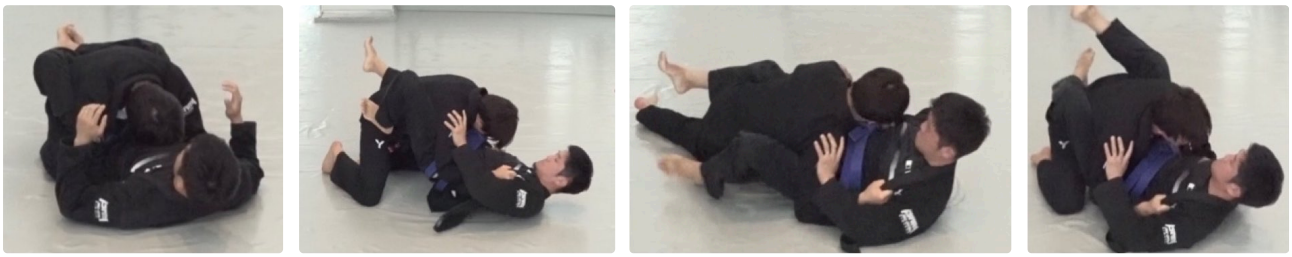
Every position has a spot where you can't be beaten. Keep going into that "safe spot and back out," and your opponent finds it hard to attack. They keep moving, trying to make something happen, and openings appear.

When you build your game, it is important to understand where those safe spots are.

People may say "that's a stalemate," but stalling takes skill too. Could you create a stalemate against a world champion? It would be hard. That is why **"a stalemate is a skill."** It is only with the comfort of this unbeatable stalemate (not getting swept, not getting submitted) that you think about passing or breaking the closed guard.

Holding position when caught in closed guard (if the opponent doesn't sit up)

- Get an underhook, or grab the gi and punch into the armpit
- Close your elbows and press your face against your opponent's chest
- If your opponent kicks your pelvis, cut your hips to evade, then come back



Holding closed guard

- Grab the belt and rock them with your legs
- Repeat many times and go for the sweep when their balance breaks



Using the lapel to control the opponent's arm, then opening the closed guard and going to mount

- Pull out the lapel, wrap it around your opponent's wrist, run it under the hips, and pass it to your other hand
- From there, start opening the closed guard
- Control your opponent's leg with a C-cup grip so the triangle choke can't come in
- Pin their knee to the mat and knee slice to side control
- From side control, go to mount





Three Types of Guard Pass

Tight base | Combat base | Standing base

Tight base

Get between your opponent's legs with both of your arms outside, grip at the armpit or the belt, put your head on them, and stay chest to chest. If your arms are inside their legs, they can control your arms, draw one of them in, and go for a triangle choke or similar. With both arms outside their legs, you are safe. The thing to watch out for is having your neck squeezed between their knees (the medial epicondyle of the femur). A squeeze from this part chokes with tremendous force, so be careful.



Create a stalemate in this position, and when your opponent starts to move, lift them up and stack them. Clamp your arms to your sides as you lift so that their shoulders come close to your knees, and control them by pushing with your chest. You can also grab the far collar and go for the neck with your forearm. Raise your knee, push their pelvis with it, grip the middle of their pants, shift them to the side, and pass to side control.








Types of Pin

Low, Middle, High

There are three types of side control pin: ① low side, ② middle side, and ③ high side. Guard passing is a game of controlling the hips (pelvis). If the hips (pelvis) can't move, you can pass. So first get to low side and control the movement of the pelvis. But from low side you can't go to a submission or to mount, so you progress to middle side and then high side.



Low side



Middle side



High side

When pinning, it is not good to underhook too deeply. Underhooking too deeply frees your opponent's pelvis. They can then shrimp to insert a knee or bridge to reverse you. It is better to control the pelvis by sandwiching it between your elbow and knee.

There are three types of mount: ① low mount, ② middle mount, and ③ high mount. Low mount is the easiest to hold, and high mount is the easiest to submit from. In low mount you can control the opponent's pelvis, so it is hard for them to bridge. In high mount, by contrast, there is no control of the pelvis, so they can bridge more easily. So start by holding mount in low mount and wearing down your opponent's stamina.

What matters in guard passing is getting your opponent's soles off you. You can only start passing once their soles are properly off you, as in stack passes and leg drags. It is also important to apply firm pressure in the direction opposite to the way you are passing. For example, when you enter with a knee cut, your opponent will block with their legs. If you pressure their legs in the direction opposite to your pass at that moment, the legs become easier to clear, and you can pass to the other side.

Guard pass with a cross grip on one leg

Grip the pant cuff of one of your opponent's legs with your opposite hand, and grip around the knee with your other hand. Shift back slightly, put your feet far away to form an arch, and pin their leg to the mat. With it pinned, circle to the side and come in low, head first. The defender shouldn't cling to grips: release immediately, use the Barbosa shrimp movement to bring the leg inside, and rotate to block the pass.



CHAPTER 05

Guard

GUARD

Guard

Not Getting Beaten Comes First

Pulling guard

There are two ways to pull guard: engage with your opponent and pull guard with one foot on their hip, or sit down immediately once you have a grip anywhere. How to choose: if your opponent isn't good on the feet, or you are, you can grip the collar and sleeve, engage, and then pull guard. But from blue belt up, people with judo or wrestling backgrounds are in the mix. If you engage with someone like that, there is a high chance you will get beaten.

So first put not getting beaten first. Getting beaten here means the opponent pulling guard first, getting taken down, or getting thrown. So it is important to stay low and, the instant you have a grip anywhere, sit quickly and pull guard first. Once you are sitting, no matter how strong your opponent is on the feet, you can't be taken down or thrown.

People also tend to move only straight up and down when they pull guard, but adding sideways movement makes it hard for the opponent to judge distance. You should always add this sideways movement in matches.

Double guard

In double guard, think about getting up before your opponent. Keep these in mind: ① grab your opponent's heel, lift it, and close the distance; ② if they grab your heel in the same way, slide your foot under their leg, get underneath, and lift their leg; ③ while you are both fighting for the legs, take the back with a berimbolo. Berimbolo in particular is something you are likely to face from brown belt up, against people who specialize in it, so you will need to practice it going forward. Double guard is a game of fighting for the underneath position, so what matters is how much faster than your opponent you can get there.

If you get up first in double guard and score the first 2 points, grip your opponent's pants, lift them, put your foot on their groin (inguinal crease), and sit as if riding them. They will push forward to stand up (if they don't push forward, you push forward and go to mount), so go straight into closed guard. You give up 2 points, but since you scored 2 first, you get into closed guard at 0 to 0.

What to do in the last minute when you are winning

Most people try to run out the clock. What matters here is the mindset of **"run out the clock while attacking."** The fighters who can do this are the strong ones. If you just run with no intention of attacking, or do nothing but defend, you give your opponent chances. Attacking here doesn't mean going for submissions. It means applying steady pressure while controlling your opponent so you don't end up inside their guard. What matters is not entering a position where they can go for a sweep. Keeping them unable to get guard, even half-beaten (holding them in a knee slice position, for example), is what running out the clock while attacking means. Top-level black belts in particular burn the clock this way.

If you could only throw rock or scissors in rock-paper-scissors, you would never lose as long as you kept throwing rock. If your opponent makes a mistake and throws scissors, you win. In the same way, what you should do in the last minute when you are winning is not a scramble that ends in a win or a loss, but a contest that ends in a win or no change. The key is to spend that minute either passing or getting put back, without taking crazy risks.

When you are about to be pinned in side control

No points are scored until the three-count. So choose one of three options: ① if you have space, recover with a Barbosa shrimp; ② if you have no space, go to your stomach, wrap up your opponent's arm or head, and reverse them; ③ if you can't wrap them up, quickly rotate from your stomach back to facing them. The key is to judge the distance from your opponent accurately.



Passing half guard

When you are caught in half guard, your opponent's only option is to get on their side, sit up, underhook, and go for a sweep, so respond in a way that prevents the sweep. First, pin their back to the mat so they can't get on their side. Be careful not to put too much weight on them here, or they may reverse you to the other side.



When your opponent tries to underhook, immediately take the inside of their arm. Then get the makura (arm under the head) and peel out their lapel. Run the lapel under their armpit to the hand doing the makura, and wring it tight. This stops them from getting on their side and sitting up. Raise your hips to make space between you and them, put your knee into that space, and sit your hips down. If your leg is entangled above the knee, grab their pants around the knee and walk your foot closer until the knee comes out. Extend your hip to push their legs down, and pull your leg free.

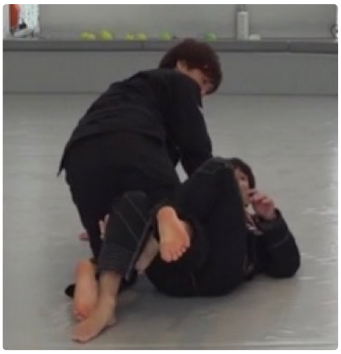


The double wrap in half guard

In a regular half guard, the wrapped legs form a triangle on the outside. A stronger way to wrap the leg is to form the triangle on the inside rather than the outside, and also wrap the ankle using a Z-foot to control your opponent. This is called the double wrap.



Regular half guard



Double wrap



Double wrap

To remove the double wrap, use the lapel for control just as you would in a regular half guard, then kick their leg away with the foot opposite the wrapped leg. Once it comes off, put the sole of your foot on the mat. With your sole on the mat, the double wrap can't be applied.









CHAPTER 06

Pins and Submissions

SUBMISSION

Pinning

The Better You Get, the More You Care About It

Side control

With the makura, clasp your hands and clamp your arm to your side, pulling in so that no gap opens between your clasped hands and your opponent's shoulder. If your face points toward their legs, they can push it with a hand and hook a leg over you. So point your face toward their face.



If you can use the lapel, use it. Pull out your opponent's lapel, run it under their armpit, and pass it to the opposite hand, the one doing the makura. Wring it tight and you can apply brutal pressure. Fix their pelvis as if sandwiching it between your knee and elbow, and they can't move. From here, go to kuzure kesa gatame. Your hips float, and you apply pressure as if gouging their solar plexus with your pelvis.

> **A submission starts with the anchor**

Without a solid anchor, a submission won't finish. A submission finishes because you take your opponent from a place where they can't move in a direction where they can move even less. It finishes because one side is firmly anchored while you pull on the other, so don't focus only on the side you are pulling. It is important to pay close attention to building the anchored base.



Weak anchor



Strong anchor

Conversely, when you think about escaping a submission, you won't get finished if you break the anchoring structure, not just the local point being attacked. Escaping by breaking this structure is stronger than working on the local point, so it is easier. For example, when someone applies an omoplata, you can escape by doing a forward roll and breaking the structure. With an armbar, rather than clasping your hands on the attacked arm and holding on, break the opponent's legs that are trapping the arm and it won't finish. If this structure can be broken, it means the pin wasn't solid. That is why submissions depend on the pin. The better someone is, the more solid their pin.

Tension

The better you get, the more firmly you can control your opponent even from the bottom. For example, apply firm tension in spider guard and your opponent can't move, and from there you can enter a triangle choke.

Strong control means "tension." Especially from the bottom, this "tension" is what stops your opponent from moving. The key is how you apply it. The kuzure kesa gatame pin also becomes a brutal pin through two tensions: the gouging into the solar plexus and the pull lifting the upper body. Downward alone or upward alone isn't enough.



What matters is how tension is applied at two points. Spider guard, too, works brutally through tension spreading left and right. Strength on one side alone gives little control. In side control and in guard from the bottom especially, it is important to be fully aware of tension at two points. Without this tension, submissions won't finish on advanced opponents.

Arch

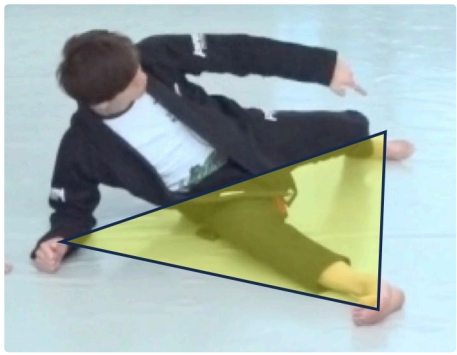
As important as tension is the "arch." With your hips on the mat you can only use a small arch from your feet to your hips, but raise your hips and you can use a big arch from your feet to your elbows.





Balance

Together with the arch, "balance" matters. Balance is the ability to keep your center of gravity inside your base of support. The wider the base of support, the easier it is to keep the center of gravity inside it, so your balance is better and you are harder to tip over. Like a camera tripod, the more evenly spaced the three legs and the farther apart they are, the wider the base of support and the more stable the balance. If the three points are close together, the base of support shrinks, the center of gravity slips outside it more easily, and you lose your balance and tip over.

Submissions From Side Control

Make Them Your Finishing Moves

Kimura after pinning the arm

From side control (kuzure kesa gatame), underhook your opponent. Then cup their wrist. Be careful: gripping hard here makes it easier for them to escape. Step on the trapped hand with your foot to pin it. Don't step straight down. Step, then extend your hip to press diagonally into the mat, and pressure goes into the arm.



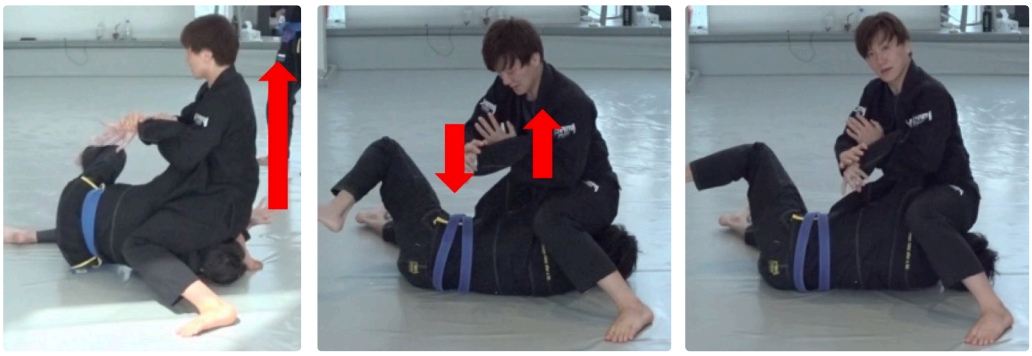


If your ankle is bent like a Z-foot, a gap opens, so make sure the top of your foot is fully extended. Using the pinning foot as your axis, switch with your other foot.






Step over your opponent's head and, while pressing the mat hard with the pinning foot, cup their elbow and pull it up. Pressing the mat hard creates strong up-and-down tension as you pull up. Switch hands, pulling the elbow up while cupping the wrist and pushing it down. When you pull up, use your spine to do it. With the elbow up and the wrist down, you get firm tension here as well.



Variation 1

Place your forearm (the radius) two fingers' width below the elbow. Turning your thumb upward makes the radius dig firmly into their arm. Push with your shoulder and straighten the elbow. Cup their hand so that their thumb points up, and finish in the direction that extends it further.



Variation 2

If your opponent resists by bending their elbow when you go for it, transition to the V1 armlock.



Variation 3

If your opponent clamps their arm to their side when you go for the elbow, put your face between their arms, step over, and pull up. To stop the kimura, they will grab their belt, so pull out the lapel and wrap it around their forearm from the outside in to fix it. With both hands fixed, they can't move. Hook your hand and finish with tsukkomi-jime (a choke where you thrust the hand in).



Variation 4

When you have underhooked from side control but can't cup the arm you want to pin with your hand, use your knee to spread the arm open and pin it.

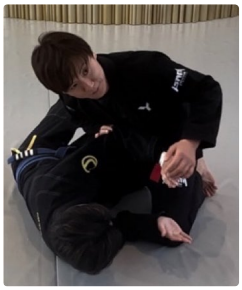


When you go for the kimura and just can't break the opponent's grip, transition to the clothespin (sentaku-basami) choke. Fall to the side as you are, sit your hips down, put the bony bump of your knee (the medial epicondyle) on their neck, and internally rotate to choke.



Variation 5

If your opponent turns fully on their side and frames, put your arm through the gap in their frame, push their face down, and wrap around the back of the neck to form a choke. Put your weight on them and rotate to finish. This is hard to finish on someone in a higher weight class. It works on people in your weight class or below.







Submissions

Front choke

You will want to set your forearm perpendicular to the neck, but perpendicular makes it easy to slip out once it's on. So instead of perpendicular, set it on the neck with your palm facing down. That way it catches firmly on the chin and is hard to slip out of.



Once you have it set so it can't slip out, go to closed guard. From there, choke as if side-bending toward the arm wrapped around the neck. Then press the legs closing your closed guard downward while using your back muscles to stretch your upper body upward, and the tension becomes strong.



Armbar

The key to the armbar is creating a long path for the arm to drop. So first, firmly trap your opponent's humerus with your legs to fix it. If this hold is loose, when you straighten the elbow the shoulder moves too, the humerus goes with it, and the armbar won't finish. Trapping firmly with your legs fixes the shoulder and humerus.

To lengthen the drop further, step on your opponent's face with your foot and lift your pelvis. This makes the path longer and the armbar easier to finish. If they still don't tap, add a side bend of your core to finish.

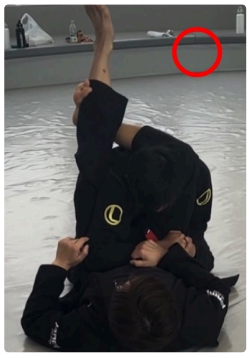
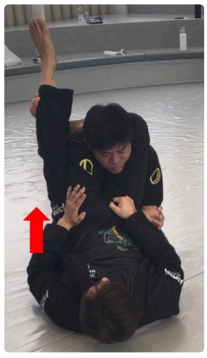
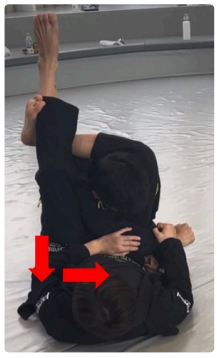


Triangle choke

The key to the triangle choke is coming in at an angle. It isn't impossible to finish from straight on, but angling drives it deeper into the neck.




If your opponent defends by posting their elbow out, don't pull them in. First extend your legs firmly and trap them so they can't move. Then lift and drop your pelvis, and clear the elbow as you come down. Repeat as many times as needed, and finish once the elbow has really cleared.

If your opponent defends by wrapping their arm around the outside so it can't be cleared, raise your hips and a gap opens between their arm and your leg. Put your hand through the gap and attack the elbow. If they hate that and release the arm, clear it and transition to a normal triangle choke.





When there is a size difference, switch the legs you have locked, turn their face to the side, and pull their head in to finish.



If your opponent defends by grabbing the pants at your thigh, hook their hand and slide it along your thigh, and the grip breaks easily. Take the freed hand straight into a mão de vaca wristlock. It's OK to bend the wrist in either direction.



If your opponent hates the triangle choke and lifts their head, hug their forearm firmly (trapping it between your chest and arm), raise your hips, and transition to an armbar.



You can also push their face aside with your hand, put your leg over the face, and transition to an armbar from underneath. When you put your leg over the face, slide it across so no gap opens. If they hate the armbar and drive forward, finish the triangle as it is.



Omoplata

Once you are in the omoplata position, the first thing to do is grab the belt or reach out so your opponent can't escape. From the omoplata position, they will escape by jumping to the far side. So grab the belt to control their movement and stop them from jumping there.






Next they will escape by doing a forward roll, so do a forward roll yourself and follow them. This puts you in a tighter position than before. Don't roll straight: roll as if riding on top of them.







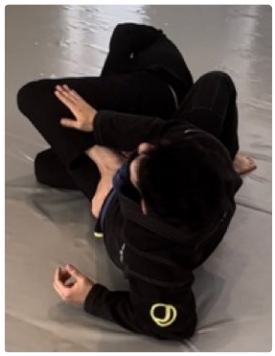
Ankle lock

The old so-called Achilles lock crushed the Achilles tendon instead of attacking the ankle joint, but in recent years it is finished in the direction of an ankle sprain (inversion). Hook your radius on the heel. Hook their foot from the inside (hooking from the outside is reaping from the outside, and falling to the inside from there is a DQ). Clamp your arm to your side and lower your shoulder blade. The more you turn toward the mat and the more you pull your shoulder back, the further the ankle bends in the direction of a sprain.






Trying to bend the ankle with your body stretched out doesn't produce much tension. Bring your hips close to your opponent and, with your body bent, pull your shoulder back as far as you can. Then extend your body at the end, and the tension comes on and it finishes.

Escaping the ankle lock

Grab your opponent's collar and push your foot out. Pushing the foot out takes the tension off the ankle. Put the sole of that foot on the mat as well, and the ankle can no longer be stretched, so it won't finish. Also, if your toes point up, force easily goes in the sprain direction, so internally rotate and point your toes inward. With your toes pointing inward, no force goes in the sprain direction.



Grab the far collar and hold the elbow, and from there it is easier to escape by pushing the foot out or pointing the toes inward.



Also, the ankle lock attacks the ankle by fixing the lower leg, so just as with the armbar, a tight sandwich is the key. Kick the inside of their thigh with your foot to stop them sandwiching.



As a counter to the ankle lock, grab one collar and one sleeve, pull them backward, put your foot on their shoulder blade, shift to the side as if side-bending your core, and attack the elbow. Or, when they fall back to finish, drive your knee onto the elbow from above and attack the elbow.



Another option is to go for an ankle lock of your own. They sandwich with both of their legs, but you sandwich with your leg and the mat, which makes it finish hard.





CHAPTER 07

Movement

MOVEMENT

Headstand




- Place your hands shoulder-width apart, externally rotate your shoulders slightly, and load the little-finger side (the pisiform)
- Put your forehead (at the hairline) down so that your hands and head form a triangle




- Forearms vertical, upper arms horizontal, elbows at 90°
- Keep your toes on the mat, raise your hips, and walk your feet in
- Rest your knees on your elbows and lift your feet
- Bring your big toes together




- Engage your core and raise your legs
- Put your fist between their knees and have them squeeze it (try not to hold their legs, because if you hold both legs they can't come down when they want to)

Adjust

- Always stand on their back side, and tell them that falling is OK and that they can come down whenever they like

Shrimp

- The escape movement for when you are pinned
- Raise your hips well so they come to the level of your shoulders, bending your body into a sideways V
- Raising your hips creates space to shift them backward

※Beginners and white belts who find it hard to raise their hips don't have to

Cueing

- Bridge and raise your hips
- Press the mat with your left foot and pull your hips back so that your right buttock comes to the position of your left shoulder, bending into a sideways V





Reverse Shrimp

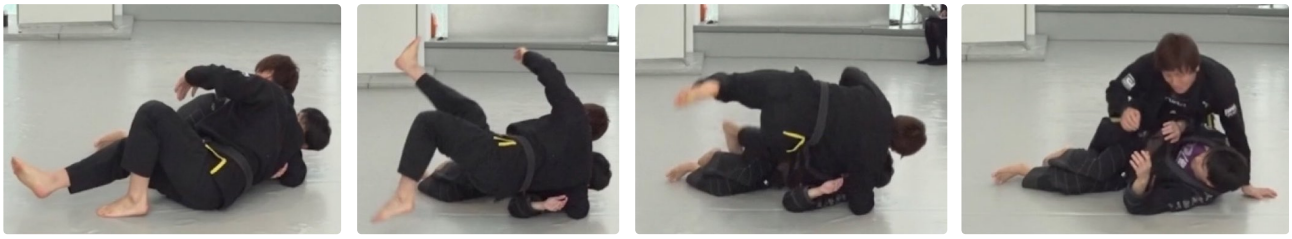
- The reverse shrimp movement has many uses
- Going from one side control to the other, hip changes in guard, and so on
- Some places teach pushing off with the opposite foot

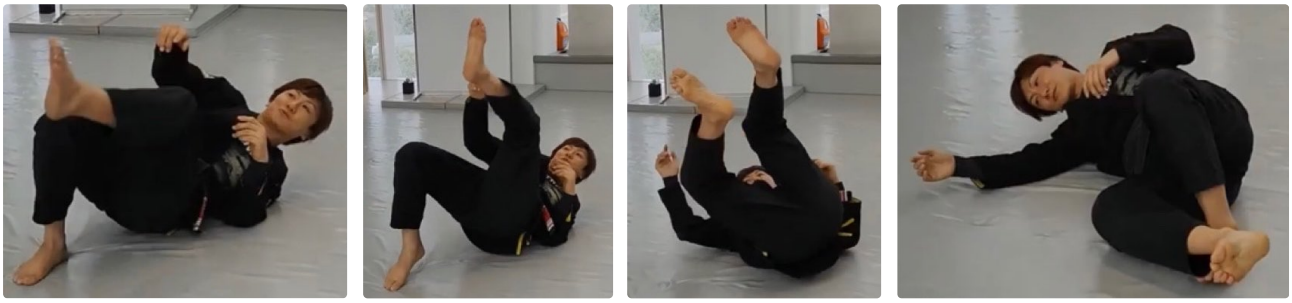
Cueing

- Lie with your left side down and point your navel in the direction of travel
- Press the mat with your right foot, lift your left buttock, and switch so that your right buttock is down

※ Stand diagonally ahead in the direction of travel, act as the target, and tell them "bring your right foot to here"

※ For people who can't kick off, first break it down and practice only the kick, then connect it







Forward Roll

- Form an inverted triangle with your feet, knee, and hand
- Thread your arm through under your armpit and roll over your shoulder
- Tuck your chin so you don't hurt your neck



Back Roll

- Start lying on your back (starting from sitting is scary)
- Put your palms on the mat
- Tilt your head as if bringing your ear to your shoulder
- Press the mat with your hands and bring your feet up beside your head

Adjust

- Always position yourself at their side
- Once their ear is close to their shoulder, hold their head with your hand so it doesn't come back
- Once their legs are up, lightly support the sacrum and push it out diagonally
- Check that their neck doesn't hurt and that they aren't scared

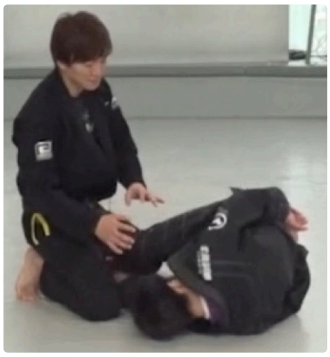





Barbosa Shrimp

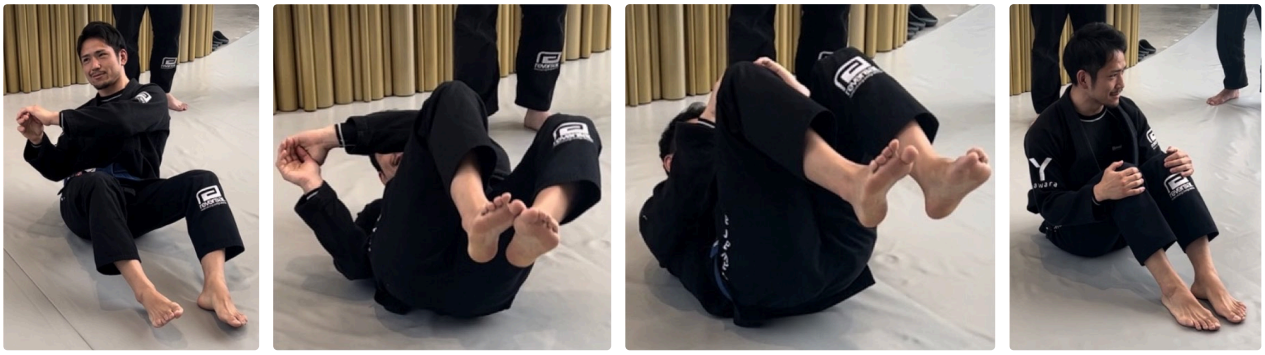
- At first, put your shoulder down diagonally forward and rotate (less likely to hurt your neck)
- If rotating is hard, rotate with your hands clasped behind you (but you never clasp your hands behind you in jiu-jitsu, so bring them back to the front once you are used to it)
- Once you are used to it, put your shoulder down directly to the side and rotate





Crab

- Rotate your thoracic spine away from the direction of travel and fall back until your shoulder blade touches
- Once your shoulder blade touches, unwind the thoracic rotation and come back up
- Gradually make the movement smaller



Seated Guard

- Let your knee fall outward and put your weight on one sitting bone
- Push your pelvis forward as if bringing your hips toward your heel
- Always keep the raised knee pointing outward so it doesn't cave in (put down the outer edge of the sole)

※A movement for adjusting the distance to your opponent



Technical Stand-Up

- Post your hand diagonally behind you (point your fingers backward so it doesn't collapse if you are pushed)
- Make a hook of your front hand and hold it in front of your face
- Keep the elbow bent so you can't be caught by a flying triangle or similar
- Support yourself on the rear hand and the opposite foot, and raise your hips
- Pull your leg back through the space under your hips and stand
- Plant the sole of the back foot fully, pointing outward

※A movement for adjusting the distance to your opponent. Turning your back on them to run is risky, so stand up while still facing them





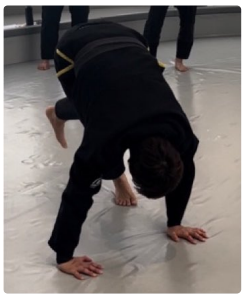





Gorilla

- Place right hand → left hand → right foot → left foot in that order, moving sideways
- In jiu-jitsu you want to get to the inside of your opponent, so place the inside foot first






Crocodile

- Think about forming an arch with your whole body
- Forming an arch puts your weight firmly on the mat (which means putting your weight on the opponent)
- Round your back slightly and spread your shoulder blades apart
- It's hard at first, so it's OK if you can just get the shape
- From all fours, place your right foot near your right hand, then spread forward and back with your left hand ahead and left foot behind
- Advance by moving your right hand and left foot forward at the same time






Dog

- The movement for standing up all at once to break a closed guard
- Post both hands in front to support yourself and place both feet beside them
- Externally rotate your hips well so your knees point outward
- Go slowly and don't rush, so you don't plant your face in the mat

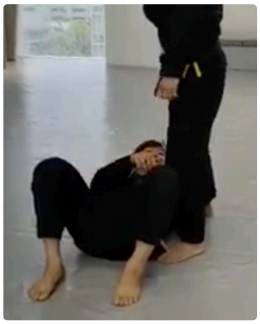



CHAPTER 08

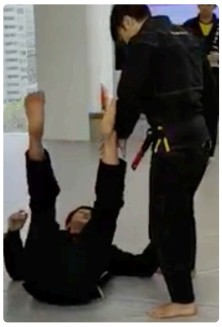
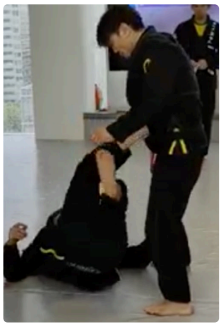
Basic Drills

DRILLS

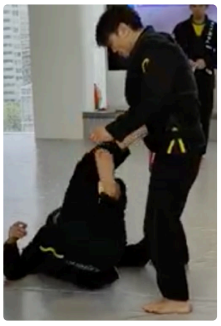
Guard Pass Drill




- Watch where the standing person stands
- Too close ×
- Stand where you can touch with your elbows bent

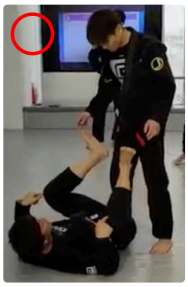
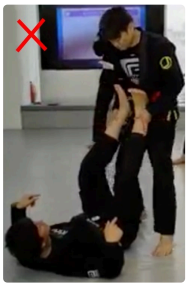



- Lifting the near leg first gets it slapped away with a hand ×
- Raise your pelvis and lift the far leg first





- Raising your hips well puts your weight on the foot you have placed, so you can push firmly
- Place the foot slightly above the belt


- Keep the leg bent, not fully extended
- If it's bent you can respond by extending it, but if it starts out straight it is easily knocked down



- Once you are pinned, don't let your hands go outside your body
- Because the image of the shrimp is so strong, people tend to brace with their hands and let them go outside the body
- Let your hands go outside your body and your opponent pins them, and you can't use them



- As when you are pinned, if your hand comes around from the outside it gets stepped on
- Always go for the inside
- If you hold the inside, you can block with your elbow even if you get stepped on



- Sandwich the pelvis firmly with your feet before you rotate

Armbar Drill



- Pull lightly with a cross grip
- Your foot must be a Z-foot




- Stay in the Z-foot and slide up the side, under the armpit
- Don't leave a gap behind your knee
- Your head comes right beside your partner (you and your partner form a cross)



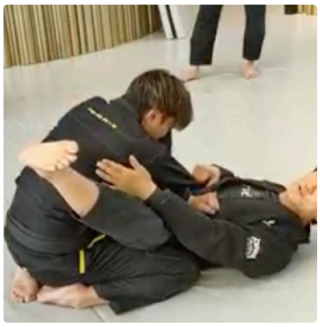

- If you cross your feet or lay the leg straight over them, space opens above their head and the head comes up




- Lay the leg with your heel turned outward and the weight of your leg goes fully onto the head, and the head can't come up




- This difference in foot position alone makes a huge difference in pressure

- Swing your leg in a big arc
- Kick at the armpit as you do in kuru-kuru
- Use a side bend of your core as well to generate rotation



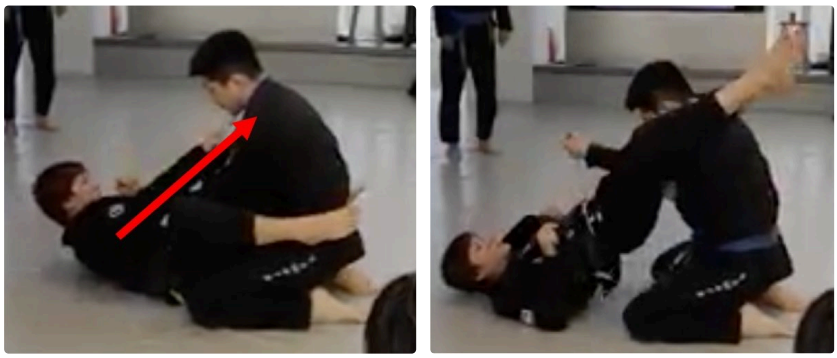
- As you reach the cross position, slide your foot up along the armpit

※If you try to slide up before you reach the cross position, you lose rotation and won't get all the way around

Triangle Drill



- Push one arm in as if punching
- Lift your hips and jump diagonally upward
- The foot on the side where the arm has cleared must always end up on top (don't get your feet reversed)
- Train until your feet lock correctly without you thinking

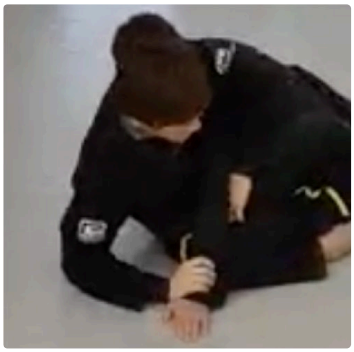


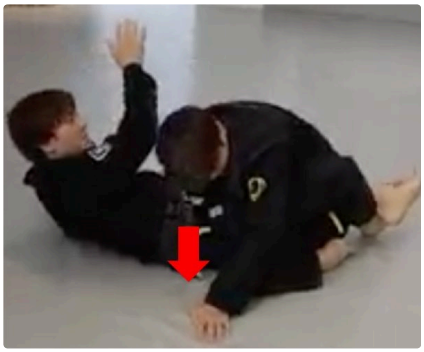
- Once you are used to it, have your partner offer just their hand and jump
- Lift your pelvis not straight up but diagonally up (toward your partner's chin)




- Always finish the triangle choke facing diagonally to the side
- Make sure your navel is pointing diagonally to the side
- The reason the triangle choke movement has you sit up is to build this diagonal turn

Kimura Drill





- Grip the arm, sit up, and bring your armpit against it
- Raising your pelvis and using the rebound as it drops to lift your body makes you faster
- Keep your inner thighs squeezed at all times

Omoplata Drill

- The receiver can get hurt if the elbow is straight, so bend the elbow, draw the shoulder blade in, and internally rotate the shoulder
- Keep your hand soft and catch it against the bone of the elbow (a soft hand makes contact with the whole hand, leaving no gap)
- If you keep your arm clamped to your side the arm gets pulled out, so open your armpit and raise your elbow
- Swing your body to the side until it is nearly parallel with your partner's, and apply it while sliding up the armpit so that your foot comes beside their ear





Spider Drill

- From spider guard, lift your hips and switch left and right
- If you face your partner squarely with your spines aligned, you can get stacked, so cut your hips to keep your spines out of line
- On top, by contrast, move so that your spine aligns with your partner's

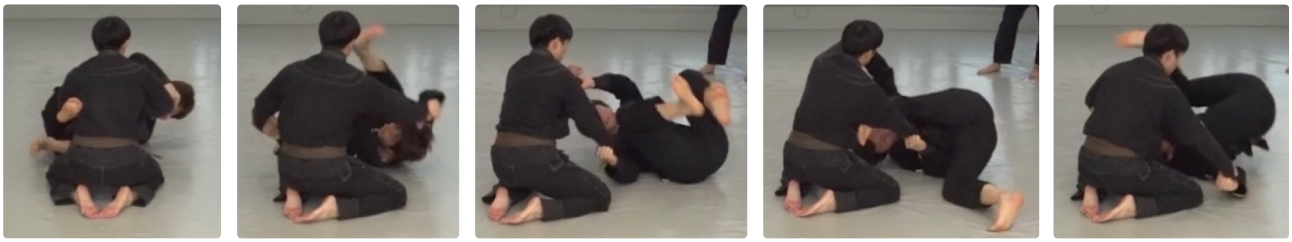




Lasso Drill

- A drill for finishing a triangle choke from lasso guard
- Set the lasso with a cross grip, rotate over your shoulder as in a Barbosa shrimp, and slam your pelvis into them to form the triangle choke





Jump Pass Drill

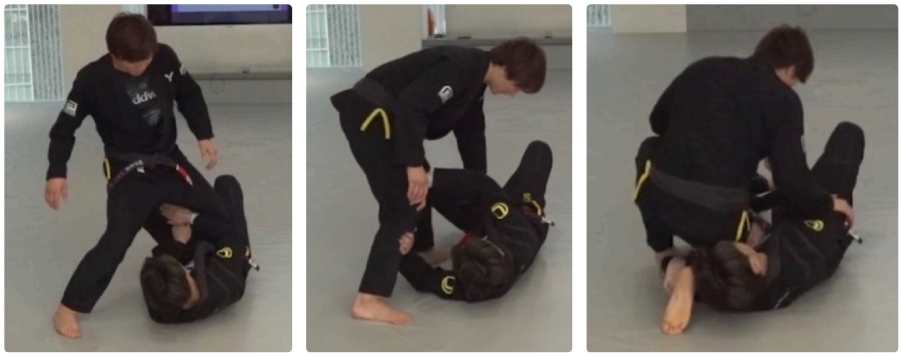
- Grip the cuffs
- Ride firmly on your partner with your shoulder
- Jump off the inside leg and land on the inside leg
- In the air, keep the option of landing on either side
- Think of kicking the mat rather than jumping



Guard Pass Drill (Stepping)

- Step so that your toes point toward your partner
- When your partner frames against your leg, you can crush the frame if your toes are pointing at them
- Imagine your toes going into your partner's belt





Toreando Pass

- Push your partner to lift their pelvis (they won't turn if their whole back is on the mat)
- Turn them as if making a big turn of a car's steering wheel



Leg Drag

- Grip your partner's leg with a C-grip and grip the cuff
- Pull your hips back, then push forward to get the sole of their foot off you
- Bring your shoulder inside, internally rotate it, and clear their leg as if punching
- Press the back of their thigh with your thigh and, using that as a pivot, push in with your fist so that their knee bends



Knee-Pin Pass Drill

- Place your hand under the ribs, along the diaphragm
- With your other hand, pin your partner's knee to the mat
- Repeat left and right
- Next, push the pinned knee so it flows downward, and go to side control





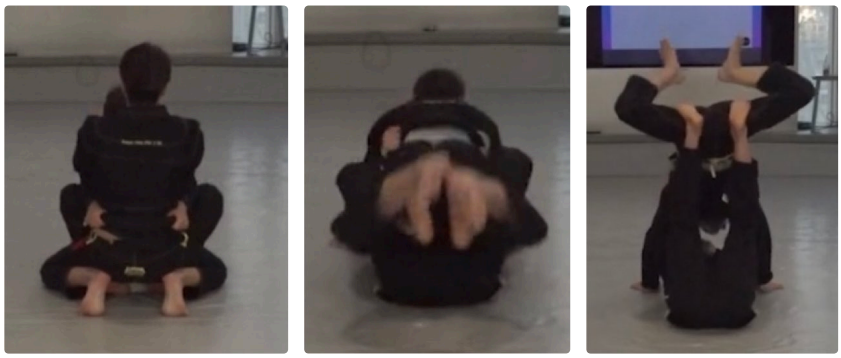
Tomoe Drill

- From the De La Riva guard shape, take one collar and one sleeve
- Make a Z-foot on the De La Riva side, leaving no gap between the top of your foot and your partner's thigh
- Place your other foot on the groin
- Bring your hips close to your partner, get underneath, and lift
- Support them firmly with the foot on the groin (the De La Riva side is support)





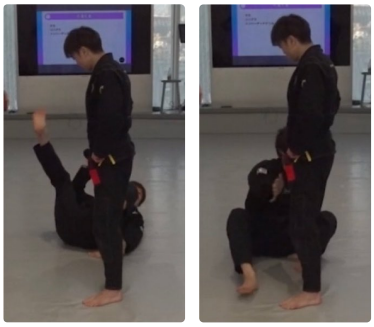
- Beginners practice lifting with both feet on the groin
- Bring your hips close to your partner and get under them
- Control your partner at all times, both going up and coming down
- Once you can control them, you can connect to the berimbolo and other moves



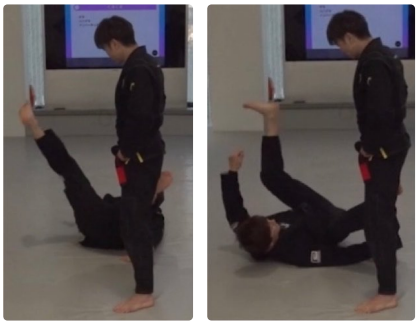
- Jump into closed guard
- Fall backward and scoop the legs with your hands
- Open the closed guard, back roll, and scoop the legs



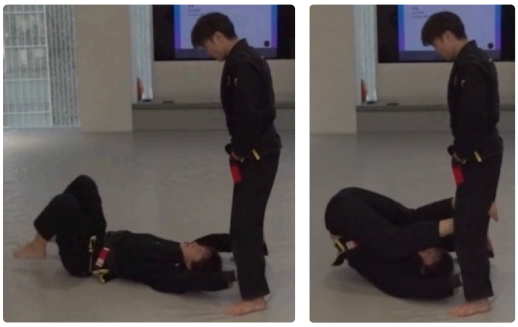
Kuru-Kuru



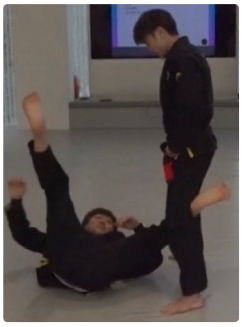
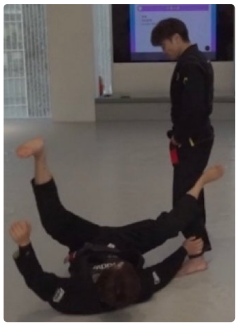
- Practice for generating rotation by swinging your hands and feet
- Use your abs as little as possible
- Touch the far side of your pelvis



- Once you are used to swinging your hands and feet, practice rotating around one leg as the axis
- The key is kicking with the foot



- Next, practice moving to the front and hooking between your partner's legs

- From between the legs, pull out one leg, swing your hands and feet, and rotate to the other side

Once you are used to it, connect these broken-down movements.

※ Reaching for the foot with your hand breaks your balance. Ideally, you rotate and your foot just ends up where your hand is.

Side Control Drill

- Have your partner underhook you
- Put the hand on the underhooked side on the mat, step over, and place your opposite elbow in front of your partner
- Wrap up your partner's underhooking arm and hold it so they can't escape